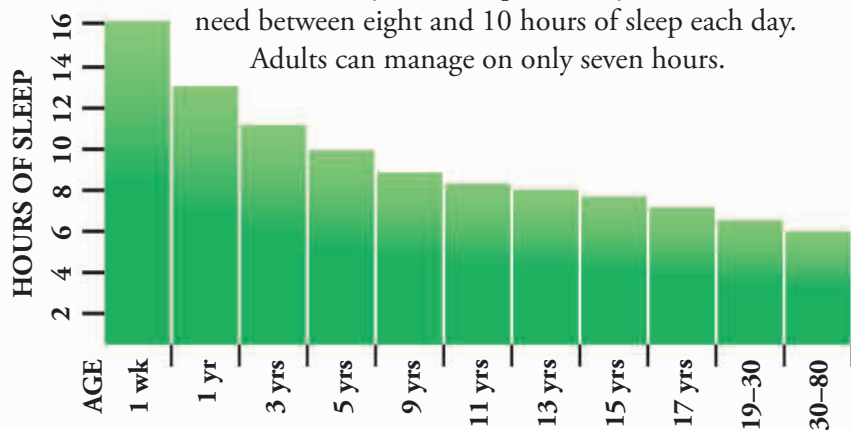


HOW MUCH SLEEP?

The older you are, the less sleep you need. Babies need as much as 16 hours a day to develop normally. Schoolchildren need between eight and 10 hours of sleep each day. Adults can manage on only seven hours.



DREAMS

No one knows why we dream, and dreams often throw up crazy, mixed-up images of people and impossible events, such as flying unaided. During dreams, the brain stops body muscles from moving, preventing us from acting out the dream, but our eyes can still move.



SLEEPWALKING

Some people get out of bed while asleep and walk around in a trancelike state with their eyes open. This is called sleepwalking. Sleepwalkers have been known to cook meals, drive cars, and even send emails, though they have no memory of doing so later. Sleepwalking takes place during deep sleep and is not connected with dreams.

BRAIN WAVES

Scientists can monitor how active our brains are by measuring the electric field generated by millions of brain cells firing at once. The electrical activity goes up and down in a wavelike pattern, and our brains generate distinctive patterns, or "brain waves," when we're active, relaxed, or asleep.



Alpha waves occur when you're awake but relaxed.



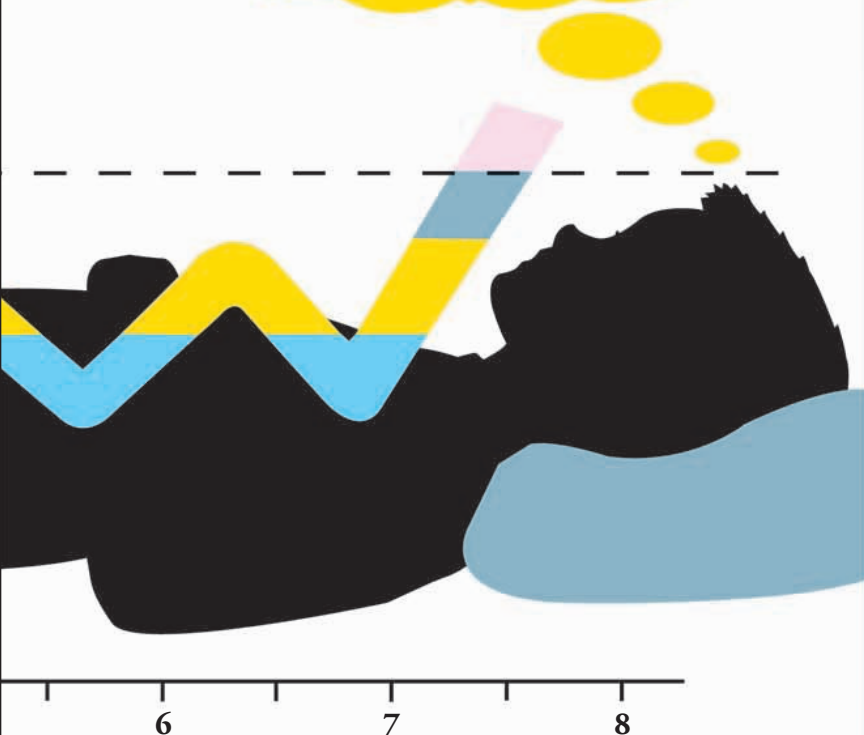
Beta waves are produced when you're alert.



Theta waves occur when you feel drowsy.



Delta waves occur during deep sleep (stages 3 and 4).



▲ STAGE 4 SLEEP

This is the deepest stage of sleep and each episode lasts for about 30 minutes.

▲ REM SLEEP

In rapid-eye-movement (REM) sleep, your eyes move under the eyelids and you have dreams.

